

INCREASING ACCOUNTABILITY

In the education space, there are ongoing efforts to digitise the education system by conducting exams, announcing results, allocating seats, etc online. However, the method of teaching and learning needs a radical change at primary and middle schools to enable the future generation to thrive in the digital world. A method has to evolve to make the best use of the digital content on the internet by changing the thought process of teachers. The problem can't be solved by installing electronic boards and projectors inside the classroom; it can't be solved by teaching Word and Excel to teachers. There is a need to create the capability of teaching by consuming online resources, adapt digital collaboration for learning purposes, motivate students' thoughts to go beyond physical boundaries of school/campus etc.

While it is great to rollout wonderful projects of Central and State governments for rural sectors, putting them into practice has been a challenge because accountability is not driven at the level of elected members and government servants at village panchayats. The Panchayat Raj bill has made way for empowerment but implementation has failed to hold people responsible. Technology can come to the rescue in driving the accountability at the last mile. A simple dashboard of all projects in every

panchayat should be broadcast regularly to citizens via local TV channels without any manual intervention. These status dashboards can be created by collating the data from variety of departments, applying digital analytics techniques and then utilising broadband to broadcast.

Rural healthcare is completely broken, not only from the point of view of care as a service but also from tracking health statistics. Technology intervention can happen on both fronts. In my opinion, the problem can't be solved by Telemedicine. The method to remotely access the regular physician/health practitioner/nurse is the need for day-to-day health issues versus the access to specialists/surgeons. The method can utilise multimedia, mobile and broadband as underlying technologies along with simple but innovative access controls in the hands of the rural citizen. Tracking of health statistics can be solved by tapping established cloud technologies."

– **RUDRAMUNI B**

Executive Director and Head of Dell India R&D



SOLVING UNEMPLOYMENT BY EMPOWERING THE YOUTH

Unemployment, inadequate Education and Healthcare facilities are three core problems that challenge India. Today we have millions who don't have access to basic education and healthcare facilities. No amount of brick and mortar work can solve these problems and India does not have time to wait for years. We need technological intervention such as Digital Transformation where cloud based e-classrooms can provide quality education to thousands of students in the most remot areas of India. Similar attempts can be launched in Healthcare sector where E-health centres can provide medical assistance to people living in far flung areas. HP has been running virtual classrooms and E-Healthcare centres across India and we are proud to say that it has delivered very good results and we have been able to solve real life problems of thousands. To solve the problem of unemployment, vocational training through future classrooms can be a game changer. Today 800 million youth are looking for opportunities to unleash their energy and creativity for the growth of the country and it is high time we adopt technological solutions that can take vocational training to masses in no time and create a strong skilled workforce to drive India's GDP growth in double digits."

– **KETAN PATEL**

Director, Personal Systems Business, HP Inc



BRIDGING THE RURAL-URBAN DIVIDE BY BOOSTING CONNECTIVITY ACROSS HINTERLANDS

There are very few problems that technology cannot address. From harnessing solar energy to resource utilisation to tackling ground-level challenges like clean water, patient monitoring, quality education for all and battling everyday city problems – technology as an enabler and a tool is ushering a big change. However, one needs to carefully weigh how accessible this tool is and how it can equip us better in India. Is the technology infrastructure adequate to address the challenges?

Ambitious strides under the umbrella of 'Digital India' bear fruition only when the core of India – the villages receive a technology overhaul. Parts of India still remain under the shadow of disconnectivity. Though India is the second largest and fastest growing mobile market, internet connectivity is minimal. Because of low internet penetration in the rural areas, a large portion of India's society fails to reap benefits of the opportunities available online. Having said that, a number of recent initiatives have ushered in a paradigm shift.

Rural mobile Internet users grew by a staggering 93% in the last calendar year, yet only 9% of the hinterland has access to technology, as per a nationwide survey done by Internet and Mobile Association of India (IAMAI) and IMRB International. In comparison to this, 53% of urban areas had mobile Internet connectivity and grew at 71% during the same period, thereby highlighting the urban-rural divide in the country. There has been a significant difference in mobile Internet usage behaviour as well. While urban India utilises technology for multifarious reasons, fully understanding its benefits, the rural population is yet to explore its full potential. For instance, the urban crowd will resort to mobile Internet for banking and transactions, but the rural community is still apprehensive.

While the benefits of technology are myriad across verticals to solve problems, we are positive that it will become a driving force for India's foundation – the villages – and soon be at par with global counterparts with respect to its absolute adoption."

– **RAHUL AGARWAL**

MD, Lenovo India

